

# Does where you live shape how long you live?

**What London's deprivation data says about housing and health, and why it matters for affordable housing**

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# Introduction: a quick brief

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| **Why** | I'm a diagnostic radiography student who has always loved geography. I wanted to explore how place and housing connect to health. |
| **Question** | Do people in more deprived parts of London have worse health, and where does housing fit in? |
| **Approach** | I reviewed public data (the English Indices of Deprivation 2025 and ONS life expectancy figures), then evaluated what it can and can't show. |

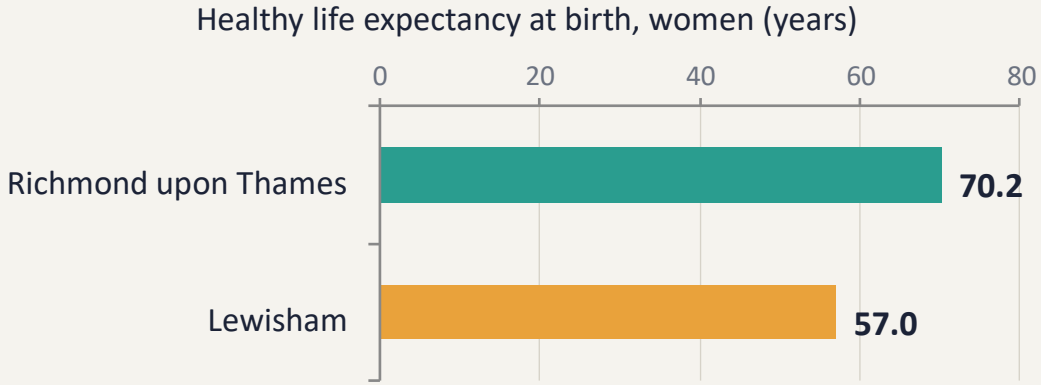
*In this deck: how deprivation is measured → the health gap → what the data can't prove → takeaways and evaluation*

# Deprivation is measured across seven areas, and two are about housing

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Income | Employment | Education | Health |
| Crime | **Barriers to Housing & Services** | **Living Environment** | **2 of 7** domains are housing-related |

The English Indices of Deprivation 2025 combine these seven domains into one measure, the Index of Multiple Deprivation (IMD). Teal = housing -related (London Sport, n.d.; MHCLG, 2025).

# Healthy life expectancy differs by 13 years across London




**13.2**

years of healthy life separate the highest and lowest borough

**86 vs 81**

Women's life expectancy (years): Kensington & Chelsea vs Barking & Dagenham

**18.2 yrs**

England-wide healthy life expectancy gap for women, most vs least deprived areas

**Newham**

Ranks as London's most deprived borough on average rank (IMD 2025)

Sources: ONS data via Trust for London (2025); London Health Commission (n.d.); OCSI (2026). Healthy life expectancy compared the highest and lowest boroughs for women, 2021 to 2023.

# Correlation is clear, but housing is only part of the story

## What the data shows

- Deprivation and health tend to move together across London
- Deprivation is uneven: between boroughs and even within them
- Low life expectancy is linked to poor diet, housing, education and employment

## What it can't prove

- Health is one of the seven IMD inputs, so some overlap is built in
- Borough averages hide neighbourhood differences
- Correlation is not causation: housing can't be isolated from income and jobs

*Housing is one lever among several, which is why affordable housing works alongside income, jobs and services.*

Sources: London Sport (n.d.); Internet Geography (n.d.); London Health Commission (n.d.).

# What this means for affordable housing

1

## Place matters

I've always loved geography, and this project showed me how where people live shapes their health as well as their opportunities.

2

## Data helps target need

Neighbourhood -level deprivation data can show where affordable homes are most needed.

3

## Housing is a partnership

Affordable housing advisers work with housing associations, local authorities, investors and developers. I want to learn how that works in practice.

Sources: Trust for London (2025); MHCLG (2025); London Sport (n.d.); Internet Geography (n.d.); Savills (n.d.). Full referenc es on the last slide.

# Summary and evaluation

## What I found

- Deprivation and health move together across London
- Healthy life expectancy for women varies by 13.2 years between boroughs
- Two of the seven deprivation domains are about housing

## Limits and next steps

- I compared the two ends of the range, not all 33 boroughs
- Health is part of the index, and borough averages hide local differences
- Next: plot every borough against deprivation rank, using neighbourhood - level data

**Bottom line: place -based data helps show where need is greatest. It is a starting point, not proof that housing alone drives health.**



# References


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